



Forge your handwriting

Researchers have developed a software that can perfectly replicate handwriting. <http://dgit.in/copyhandwrite>



Uber's self-driving cars

Uber is set to launch a self-driving car fleet in Pittsburgh with people initially. <http://dgit.in/ubersdcars>

Creativity Unleashed

What technology companies are doing to unleash their employees' creativity.

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"Creativity is just connecting things. When you ask creative people how they did something, they feel a little guilty because they didn't really do it, they just saw something. It seemed obvious to them after a while. That's because they were able to connect experiences they've had and synthesize new things."

—Steve Jobs

Yoshiro Nakamatsu, an 88 year old Japanese inventor, who licensed his floppy disk patents to IBM and has more than 3500 patents to his name, has a very 'different' creative process using which he claims to have had most of his best ideas. The process involves listening to music, meditation, and finally diving underwater, and writing the ideas while being down there.

Steve Jobs, one of the many famous people known to have used Acid to 'unleash their creativity', once said, "Acid is one of the 2 or 3 most important things I have done in my life." He is known to have even asked a potential employee in an interview, if he had ever done LSD. The employee said no and left the interview midway saying maybe the job wasn't for him. In a fast moving place like the technology world, innovation and creativity are necessary to remain at the top, and this is no secret amid silicon valley giants.



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Even if they are not sending their employees underwater or giving them free Schedule 1 drugs, everyone from companies like Google, Facebook, Netflix to smaller startups are going to great lengths to unleash their employee's creativity and increase their productivity.

Today, we take a look at what some of the top tech companies around the world do to unlock their employee's creative potential and the various successful products and services that have come out of it. Who knows - even you might be inspired by a few of these!

Hackathons

The Famous Facebook hackathons

Generally lasting between a day and a week, hackathons are like sleepovers for geeks. And if you are working for one of the biggest tech companies in the world, add free food and beer to it, and you are all set for 24 hours of non stop hacking and putting your creativity and skills to test. All the while, you get paid to do it. Conducted every 6 to 8 weeks, these all night coding fests have long been a part of Facebook's startup-esque culture.

According to Pedram Keyani, the man who made these hackathons a regular thing at Facebook, there is only one rule in these events, "you can't work on the same thing that you work on during the day". From 'Kegerators' to nifty little features that have altered the course of the billion dollar company, these hackathons have given birth to a number of good ideas.

Here is a list of Facebook features you wouldn't believe have come out of these 24 hour hackfests:

- Facebook Chat- Believe it or not, the Facebook chat was the product of one such 24 hour long hackfest way back in 2008. Surprisingly there was a lot of negative pressure against incorporating a chat client in the still growing social media site at the time. One employee believed otherwise and proved them wrong in the best way possible.